building and they mainly distributed copies of the advertisement in The Nevj York Times. The R&AW officers and Indian diplomats had informally advised leading members of the Sikh community in New York to dissociate themselves from this irresponsible demonstration which was inspired and financed by Pakistan.

This is what Chohan had written in The New York Times advertisement:

The world has been oblivious to the fate of 12 million Sikhs living under political domination in India and in constant fear of genocide. Another 6 million of us live abroad in alienation and exile waiting for the day of deliverance. An independent Sikh state in the Punjab is the only guarantee for peace in the sub-continent. This is a fact, which the United Nations must recognize. An independent Sikh state will act as a buffer between India and Pakistan. It will be a restraining influence on the two countries. It is the only solution, which can prevent a holocaust on the sub-conti-

nent. There will always be a Sikh nation. There always has been. Let the Hindu rulers in Delhi understand this because if they persist in their treachery and deceit, the sub continent will be engulfed in a war the like of which the world has never seen. The clock has come full circle. No longer can we wait in silence for the Indian government to wipe us out. We have decided to rise and proclaim to the world that we are an undivided nation prepared to fight till the bitter end for an independent Sikh homeland in India.

Days later, on 18 October 1971, an intelligence report from Washington said Pakistani agents were pursuing and persuading thousands of Sikhs settled mostly in the west coast,